



A spinning mystery: Mithali Raj, mentor of Gujarat Giants, said, "If it (tournament venue) has a spinning track, then every team would be happy because they are all stacked up with spinners. The question is, on a batting track, how good would those spinners be?" SPORTSPICS/BCCI

between Mumbai Indians and Delhi, with the latter ultimately sealing the deal. With its core set of players already intact, the Capitals wanted someone who could be multi-skilled. The seasoned Sutherland happened to be the perfect fit.

"The staff wanted Sutherland and the Indian players (Aparna Mondal and Ashwani Kumari). After discussing about it, we eventually got them. The squad has been good since last year, so they are valuable additions," Sourav Ganguly, former India captain and Delhi Capitals' director of cricket, said.

The Adani Sportsline-backed Gujarat Giants, having left out half of its squad, had several gaps to fill. It

managed to make some smart acquisitions, spending ₹1 crore on Phoebe Litchfield, along with Meghna Singh, Trisha Poojitha, Priya Mishra, Lauren Cheadle, Kathryn Bryce, Mannat Kashyap, Tarannum Pathan, and Veda Krishnamurthy.

England's Danni Wyatt (Warriorz) and Kate Cross (RCB) found takers, while South Africa quick Shabnim Ismail was picked up by Mumbai for ₹1.2 crore.

"The extra pace is something that we wanted. She is one of those players who brings a lot to the group. I'm really excited about having her on board," Charlotte Edwards, Mumbai's coach, commented on the inclusion of Ismail.

Among capped Indians, seasoned campaigner Ekta Bisht attracted the highest bid of ₹60 lakh for RCB, while Devika Vaidya did not find any takers.

When the auction concluded, the teams appeared satisfied with their overall selections, despite lacking clarity on the tournament's venue. In line with the inaugural edition, when the state of Maharashtra hosted all

the matches (Mumbai and Navi Mumbai), BCCI secretary Jay Shah has mentioned that the upcoming edition would take place in one state again.

However, with no clarity on the preferred state, the franchises proceeded to pick players they believed would perform well in any condition.

"I would say that if it's a spinning track, then every team would be happy because they are all stacked up with spinners," said Mithali.

"The question is, on a batting track, how good would those spinners be? How good are your uncapped spinners... It depends on that."

"In leagues of this nature, you would like to see high scoring games and chases. Therefore, every franchise is looking to gather a top-heavy batting side."

With the auction over, it's time for the franchises to wait and watch before finalising their strategies for the tournament, which is expected to begin on February 22.